HOW WE TESTED

Performance and battery tests
Synthetic benchmarks are not the always the best reflection of how a device performs in real life, but they are the first step to find how competent these phones are. We ran all the mentioned benchmarks and recorded the outcome. Benchmarks also provide a comparative score with phones that haven't been included in this comparison, which gives us even better insight. Of course, we don't depend on them alone, but you get the point.

To test the battery life of the phones, we used the standard Geekbench battery test. After charging the phones to 100 percent, displays of all smartphones were turned to full brightness. After that, we simply started the battery benchmark and let it run till the battery died. There's also a looping video test that we use, and together, these two gives us a really good idea of the battery life, which is then justified by real world usage.

Real life tests
To test the real world performance, we devised tests, ranging from gaming to regular simpler apps, testing them out on the phones side by side. Even though some phones have 3GB of RAM and some of the contenders just offer 2GB of RAM, we tested them on equal parameters for multi-tasking. We also tried playing multiple games on the phones, simultaneously, checking how long it took them to give up.

Camera test
We conducted our camera tests in various of light conditions — dawn, daylight, overcast, studio (fluorescent), tungsten, night, low light and flash. Video recording tests were done out of fast moving vehicles, of fast-moving objects from a stationary point, still objects, and low light situations to test noise levels and frame interpolation in the recorded videos. We also tested the phones on aspects like shutter speeds and focusing times.

Design and Usability
The ten contesting phones were judged on the following parametres — Looks, build quality of the phone, build quality of the display, interface design, and ergonomics. Even though these are just budget phones, build quality is given much importance.

The competitors in this test were — Huawei Honor 5C, LG K10, Lava X81, Xiaomi Redmi Note 3, Meizu M3 Note, Asus Zenfone Max ZC550KL, LeEco Le 1s (Eco), Xiaomi Redmi 3S Prime, Coolpad Note 3 Plus, Lenovo Vibe K5 Plus.

more ergonomic. The edges are now more rounded and making it feel smaller than its size. The choice of material is still metal but it feel more premium compared to previous budget phones from the company. Further, the build quality is certainly better than most of its competitors.

Like most budget smartphones, the Honor 5C brings a Full HD resolution to the table, although on a slightly smaller 5.2-inch display, which adds to the ergonomics and pixel count of the display. The smaller display is fairly sharp and vibrant for a budget phone. It is bright enough to be seen under direct sunlight but lacks any kind of screen protection.

The Honor 5C is the only phone in India to be powered by a HiSilicon Kirin 650 SoC. This is a custom SoC developed by Huawei for its budget smartphone, which like most SoCs is based on ARM's big.LITTLE architecture. This octa-core SoC combined with 2GB of RAM is able to sail through most tasks quite smoothly. The phone works quite well with social media apps, chat apps and music streaming in the background, but sluggishness can be observed on the phone from time to time. Gaming experience on the phone was not that bad either, but heavier game titles such as Asphalt 8 stutter now and then. That said, less demanding games, such as Jetpack Joyride, work just fine.

The 13MP rear camera on the phone does a good job in well lit conditions and the images taken showcase good saturation levels and the colours reasonably close to source. The 8MP front facing camera doesn't disappoint either and is good for taking selfies, and that is what these are mostly used for.

LG K10

The LG K10 is LG's bid in the smartphone segment. The phone relies on a plastic build which is quite good but still inferior compared to the various smartphones offering a metal build in the budget segment. The design of the phone is typical LG as the volume rocker and the power key are situated at the back below the rear camera. The functionality is the same but the unorthodox positioning requires some getting used to. The design is certainly a highlight of the phone as the pebble like look, rounded edges and the 2.5D curved display makes it ergonomic and good looking.

The 5.3-inch display is nice to look at, has good viewing angles, is sharp enough and offers good sunlight legibility. On the flipside, it is just a 720p display, which for a phone priced around 10K, is not good enough. The UI is typical LG with big widgets, distributed settings and LG made apps. The UI feels messy, making each home screen seem overcrowded, but at the end of the day, it is functional.

When it comes to performance, the phone seems like it was made in 2014. To be quite blunt, the Qualcomm Snapdragon 410 SoC powered device, got the lowest performance scores recorded during this shootout. While it is able to run all essential tasks such as messaging, social media apps, browser and video playback, its capabilities are limited. In addition, with multiple apps running in the background, the phone lags and stutters consistently. As for the 13MP rear camera on this phone, it does a decent job but it still lags behind the competition. The phone also has the poorest battery life in this shootout, making it a hard choice to root for.